

LING 201 Ambiguous Sentences

Below is a list of ambiguous sentences. Please try to draw the trees on your own before checking the answers, which begin on the next page. The sentences are:

I saw a man with binoculars.

Fatima read a book on the desk.

The clown scared the girl with a mask.

Tom greets the girl with a broad smile.

Tom hid the ball in the garage.

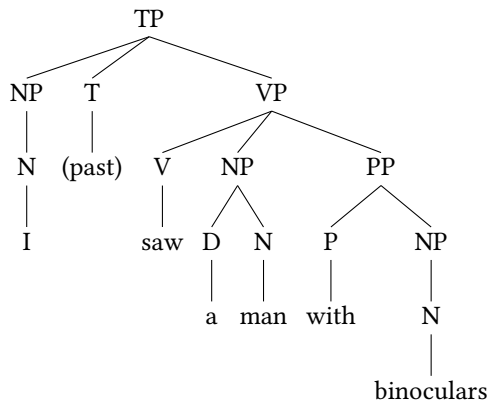
John said Mary went to the store quickly.

I shot an elephant in my pajamas

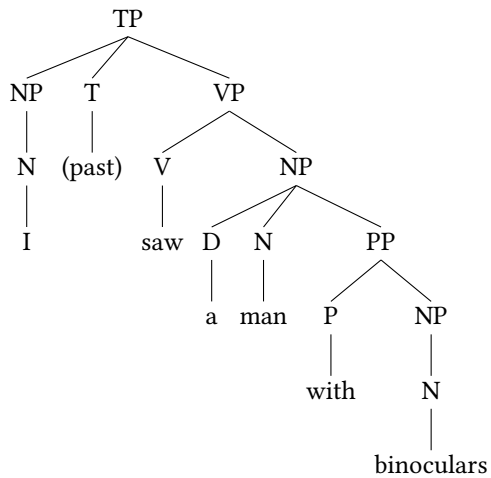
John said that Mary left on Tuesday.

(1) I saw a man with binoculars.

a. Meaning 1: I used binoculars to see a man.

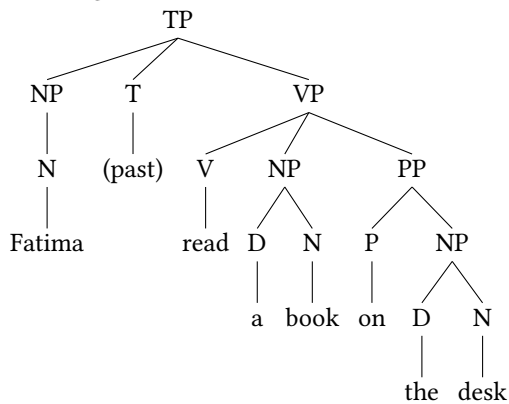


b. Meaning 2: I saw a man who had binoculars.

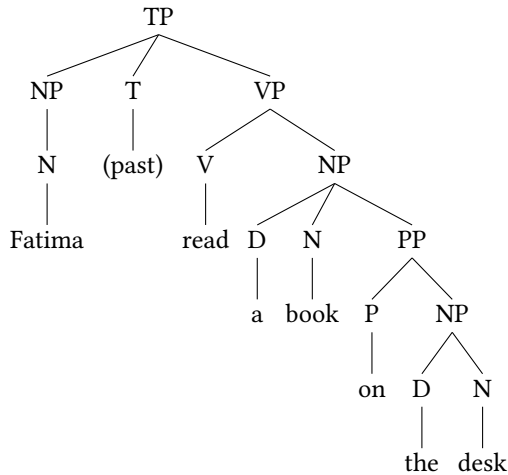


(2) Fatima read a book on the desk.

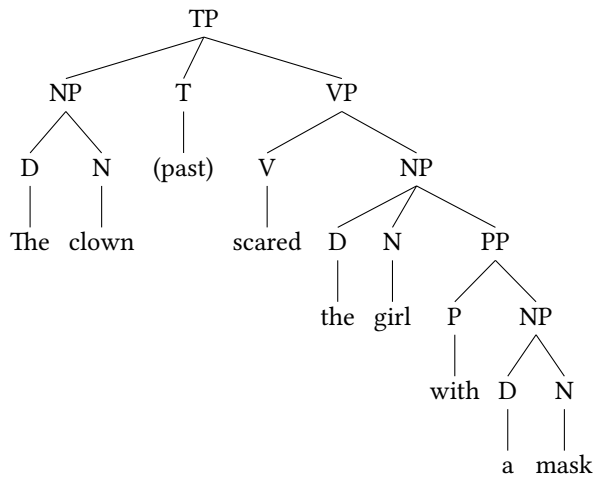
a. Meaning 1: Fatima read a book while she was sitting at the desk.



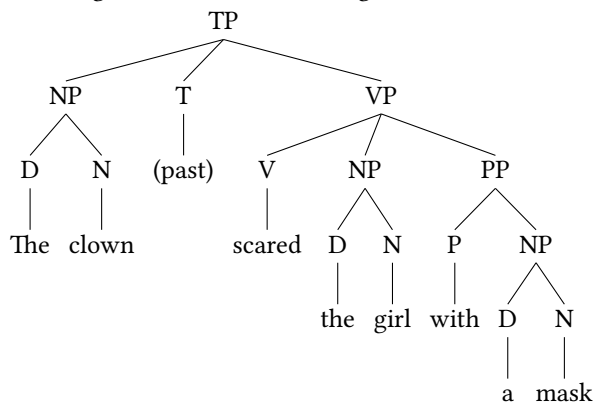
b. Meaning 2: Fatima read a book that was lying on the desk.



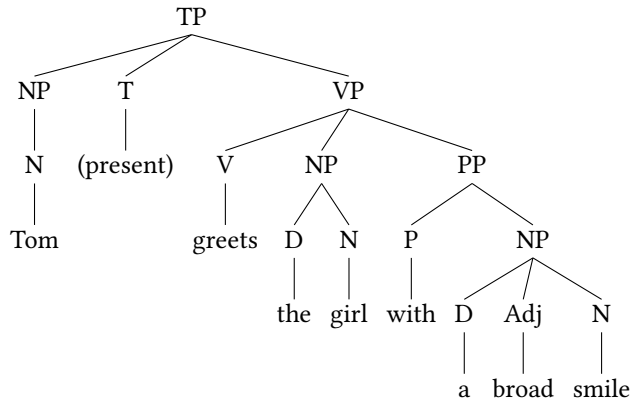
- (3) The clown scared the girl with a mask.
 a. Meaning 1: The clown scared a girl and the girl is wearing a mask.



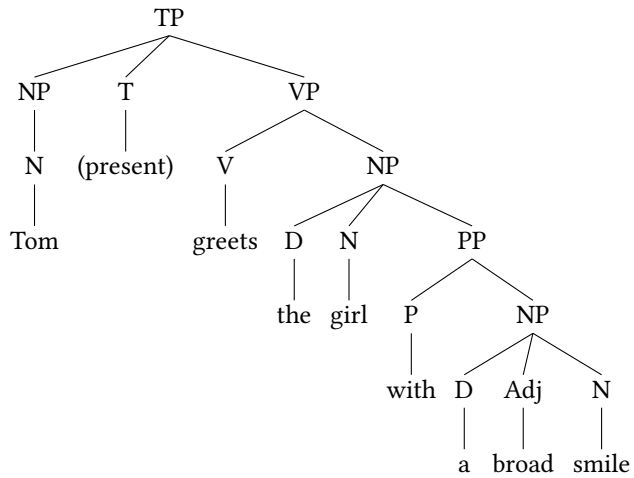
- b. Meaning 2: The clown is wearing a mask and he scared the girl because of that.



- (4) Tom greets the girl with a broad smile.
 a. Meaning 1: Tom smiles broadly and greets the girl.

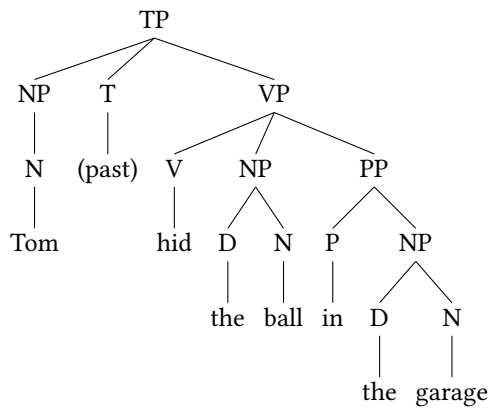


b. Meaning 2: Tom greets the girl who is smiling broadly.

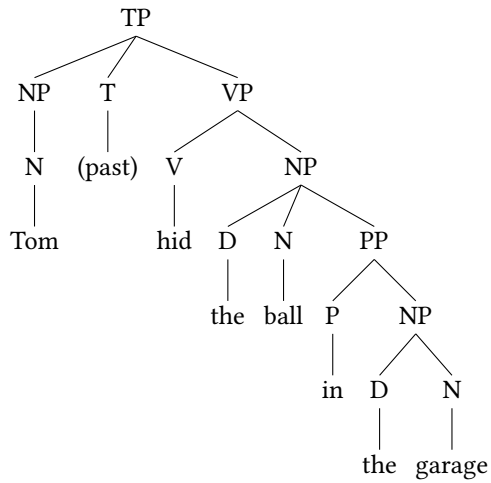


(5) Tom hid the ball in the garage.

a. Meaning 1: It was in the garage that Tom hid the ball.

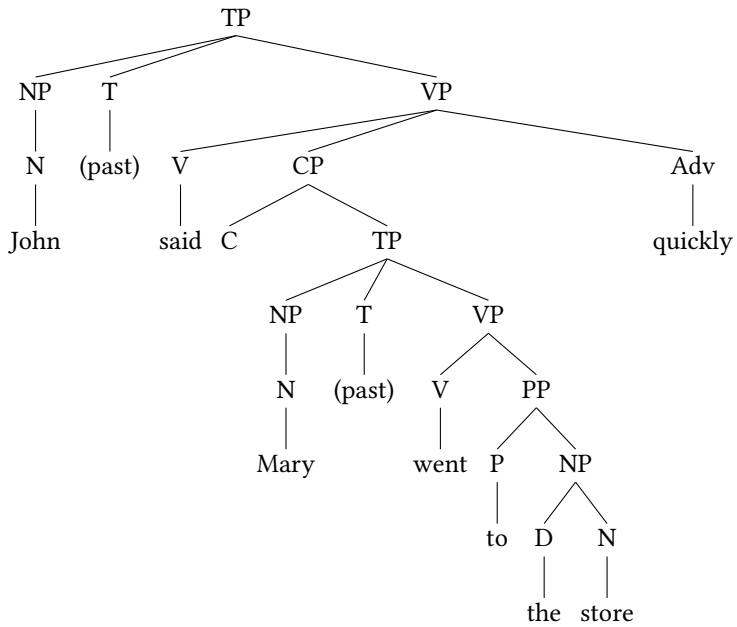


- b. Meaning 2: It was the ball in the garage that Tom hid.

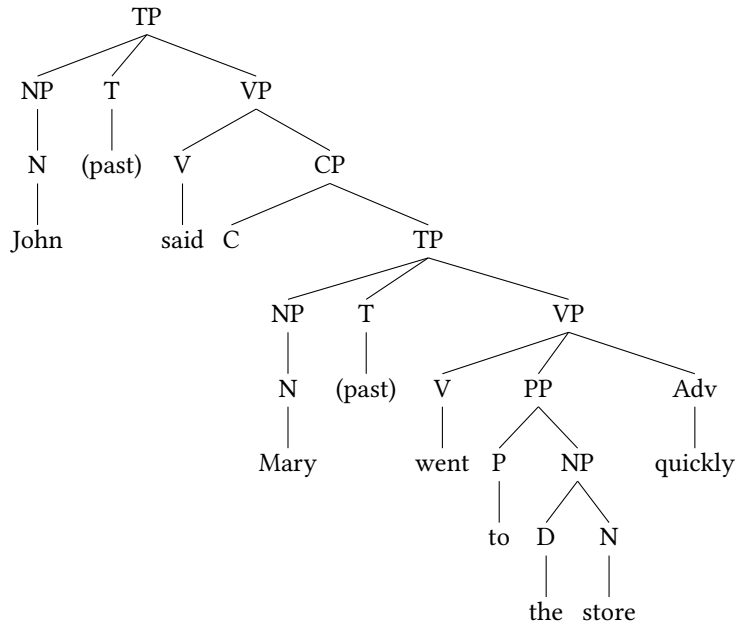


- (6) John said Mary went to the store quickly.

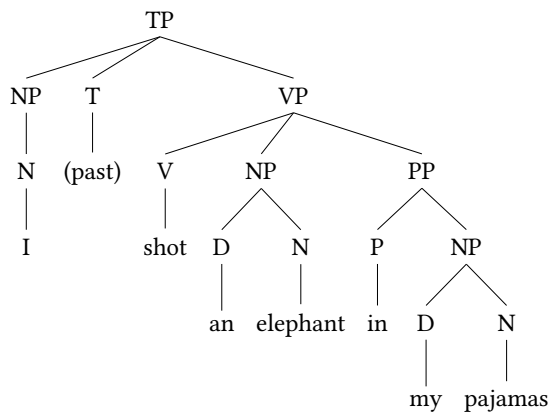
- a. Meaning 1: John said Mary went to the store and he did so quickly.



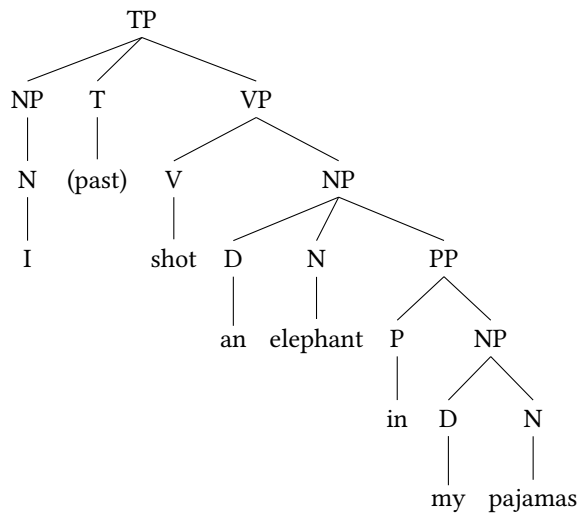
- b. Meaning 2: John said Mary went to the store and she did so quickly.



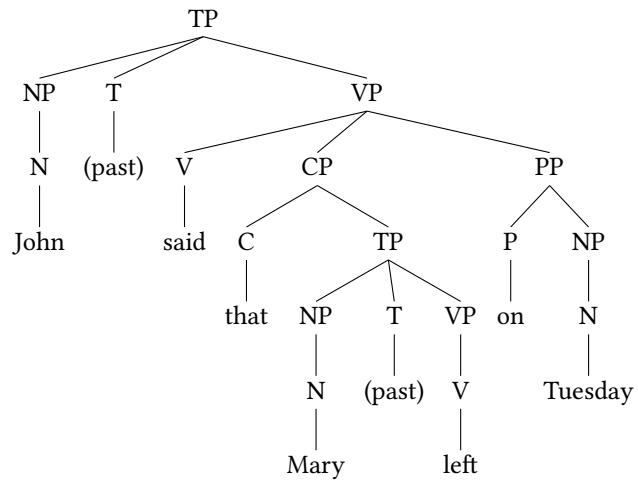
- (7) I shot an elephant in my pajamas:
 a. Meaning 1: I shot an elephant when I was in my pajamas.



- b. Meaning 2: I shot an elephant and that elephant was in my pajamas.



- (8) John said that Mary left on Tuesday.
 a. Meaning 1: John said on Tuesday that Mary left.



- b. Meaning 2: Mary left on Tuesday and this was what John said.

